WINDOWS DESKTOP APPLICATION / USER MANUAL

Greek to Greeklish Renamer

Rename confidently. Preview every change.
Keep English filenames untouched.

Per-file checkboxes / Manual name editing / CSV undo

Live progress bar / Standalone Windows EXE

VERSION 2.1.1 / OPEN SOURCE / MIT LICENSE

Created by Dimitris Laidis

github.com/DimitrisLai/Greek-to-greeklish-renamer

01 / Start here

Choose the correct download, then complete a safe first run in a few minutes.

Which file should I download?

DOWNLOAD	WHO IT IS FOR
Windows ZIP (recommended)	Contains the compiled **GreeklishRenamer.exe**, PDF manual, license and quick-start text. **No Python installation.**
Source ZIP	For developers and Python users: GUI, command-line edition, tests, documentation and build scripts.
PDF User Manual	This document; also included in the Windows ZIP.

Your first scan in six steps

- **1.** Download the Windows ZIP from the v2.1.1 GitHub Release.
- **2.** Right-click the ZIP and choose **Extract All**.
- **3.** Double-click **GreeklishRenamer.exe**.
- **4.** Browse to a test folder with a few Greek filenames.
- **5.** Leave subdirectories disabled at first; click **Preview changes**.
- **6.** Untick rows to skip and Edit incorrect proposals; apply only checked rows.

START SAFELY

Make a separate backup before bulk changes. The preview does not modify files. A CSV undo log is created for each applied run.

02 / Meet the desktop interface

A focused window for selecting a folder, reviewing changes, applying renames and restoring names.

Screen guide

AREA	WHAT IT DOES
Folder location	Enter a directory or choose Browse... to open the Windows folder picker.
Include subdirectories	Process files within nested folders; off by default.
Also rename Greek folder names	Optional and only available when subdirectories are included.
Preview changes	Build a read-only plan with current paths and proposed names.
Select All / Select None toggle	One toggle switches between Select None (all checked) and Select All (otherwise).
Edit selected...	Select a row or double-click it to edit the proposed filename only.
Apply renames	Confirm, validate selected names and log changes actually performed.
Export preview	Save the proposed changes to CSV without modifying files.
Undo from CSV	Select a previous undo log and type **UNDO** to restore names.

IMPORTANT DETAIL

An unticked row stays unchanged. Changing the folder or scan options clears the preview; make a new preview before applying.

03 / The preview-first workflow

The application is designed to make each proposed change visible before committing it.

What you see before renaming

TYPE	CURRENT PATH	PROPOSED PATH
File	Ελληνικά.mp3	Ellinika.mp3
File	DJ - Ελληνικά.flac	DJ - Ellinika.flac
Folder	Μουσική	Mousiki
File	Αθήνα/Τραγούδι.mp3	Αθήνα/Tragoudi.mp3

Choose, correct and apply only what you want

- Every candidate starts with a visible checkbox in the INCLUDE column. Click it, or press Space on a highlighted row, to skip or include that item.
- One button above the table switches between **Select None** (all checked) and **Select All** (otherwise).
- Select a row and click **Edit selected**, or double-click the row, to customize its proposed filename.
- Pressing **Apply renames** confirms and applies **only checked rows**. Follow the live progress bar, percent and processed/renamed counters.
- Before applying, the tool recomputes the plan. If the folder changed, the operation is rejected and a new preview is required.
- Skip child changes safely: uncheck the parent folder when a child is excluded.
- The CSV undo log contains only completed changes. Export preview includes selected/edited flags.
- If files are locked, missing or permissions fail, some changes may be skipped; review the completion count and retain the log.

DO NOT TREAT PREVIEW AS A FILE-CONTENT COMPARISON

This tool modifies filenames and directory names, not media metadata, contents, lyrics or audio. It does not compare hashes or file quality.

04 / Folders and subdirectories

Control scope independently: scan inside subfolders, and optionally rename the subfolders themselves.

INCLUDE SUBDIRECTORIES	RENAME GREEK FOLDERS	BEHAVIOR
Off (default)	Disabled	Only files directly inside the selected folder are considered.
On	Off	Files are considered recursively; folder names remain unchanged.
On	On	Files and Greek-named folders are candidates for renaming.

Example: an artist collection

```
BEFORE  /  Music / Ελληνικά / Τραγούδι.mp3

AFTER   /  Music / Ellinika / Tragoudi.mp3
```

With the second option disabled, **Ελληνικά** remains the same folder name, while **Τραγούδι.mp3** becomes **Tragoudi.mp3**.

Linked directories are excluded

- Recursive scans skip symbolic links and Windows junction / reparse points.
- The selected root directory must be a normal accessible folder, not a link.
- Folder moves are performed after filenames inside the folder, so the undo log can restore paths in reverse order.

05 / Greek-to-Greeklish rules

Simple ASCII transcription inspired by ELOT 743 / ISO 843, with Greek accents removed.

ORIGINAL	RESULT	NOTES
Γιώργος Μαζωνάκης.mp3	Giorgos Mazonakis.mp3	Greek name example
Δημήτρης Κόκοτας.flac	Dimitris Kokotas.flac	File extension preserved
DJ - Ελληνικά.mp3	DJ - Ellinika.mp3	Mixed Latin / Greek
Χρήστος.mp3	Christos.mp3	χ → ch
Μπάμπης.mp3	Bampis.mp3	Context-dependent μπ
Αυτοκίνητο.mp3	Aftokinito.mp3	Context-dependent αυ
English Song.mp3	Unchanged	No Greek letters

A note about spelling

Personal names have more than one accepted Latin spelling. This software aims for consistent filename-friendly ASCII results; it is **not a certified, fully reversible or exhaustive ELOT 743 implementation**. Review names that matter to you.

GREEK-ONLY FILTER

The application examines each file or folder **name**, never its content. English or already-Greeklish names are skipped.

06 / Safety, conflicts and undo

The GUI protects unrelated names, but important collections should still be backed up.

Collision behavior

EXISTING NAME	GREEK ORIGINAL	RESULT
Ellinika.mp3	Ελληνικά.mp3	Ellinika (2).mp3
Ellinika (2).mp3	Ελληνικά.mp3	Ellinika (3).mp3 (if needed)

Restoring names

- Keep the **greeklish_rename_log_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS_microseconds.csv** created in the chosen folder.
- Click **Undo from CSV** and select the log from the run you want to reverse.
- Manually edited names are restored like automatic names; unchecked rows do not appear in the undo log.
- Verify that the folder is correct, then type the exact word **UNDO**.
- Undo processes changes in reverse order. If a source is missing or an original destination is now occupied, it skips that row rather than overwriting.

UNDO IS NOT AN INDEPENDENT BACKUP

Do not delete your separate backups until you verify the results. A crash, locked file, moved directory, concurrent changes or filesystem error can prevent full restoration.

07 / Source edition and command line

The original command-line renamer remains available for automation and users who prefer console controls.

Run the Python GUI (source edition)

```
py greeklish_gui.py
py greeklish_gui.py --version
py greeklish_gui.py --self-test
```

Keep using the command-line edition

```
py rename_greek_to_greeklish.py
py rename_greek_to_greeklish.py --path "D:/Music" --dry-run
py rename_greek_to_greeklish.py --path "D:/Music" --recursive
py rename_greek_to_greeklish.py --path "D:/Music" --recursive --files-only
```

Undo from PowerShell or Command Prompt

```
py rename_greek_to_greeklish.py --path "D:/Music"
  --undo "D:/Music/greeklish_rename_log_...csv"
```

The two-line undo example above is conceptual; put it on one command line, or use the GUI. The **--yes** flag skips the CLI confirmation prompt and should only be used deliberately.

08 / Troubleshooting

Quick checks for common problems in the Windows UI and Python source edition.

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
The EXE does not open	Extract the ZIP first. Windows SmartScreen may prompt on an unsigned community-built EXE; download only from the official GitHub Release.
Nothing found	Check the selected folder and subdirectory option. Only names containing Greek letters qualify.
Apply is disabled	Run Preview and check at least one row; changing options clears the preview.
Bulk selection seems wrong	Use the checkbox in INCLUDE for a single row; the one bulk button switches between Select All and Select None.
Progress looks slow	The percent tracks completed attempts. Locked or missing files can be skipped and appear in the final count.
Edited name is rejected	Use a unique name in the same folder, without reserved Windows characters.
Unchecked child blocks Apply	Uncheck the selected parent folder too, or explicitly select the child.
Folder changed before apply	Run Preview again; the stale plan is intentionally rejected.
Access denied / locked file	Close music players, editors or sync clients. Check permissions and try again.
Undo restores only some rows	Review the CSV and check for moved/missing files or occupied original names.
Source GUI fails to start	Confirm Python 3.10+ includes Tkinter. Use the standalone EXE if Python is not available.

WINDOWS BUILD DISCLAIMER

The GitHub workflow tests the engine on Windows and Linux and builds a Windows EXE. You should still smoke-test launching and renaming on your own Windows desktop.

09 / Project information

Release details, support channels and responsible use.

ITEM	DETAIL
Project	Greek to Greeklish Renamer
Release	v2.1.1 — Selective Renaming
Author	Dimitris Laidis / GitHub: DimitrisLai
License	MIT (source code); dependencies keep their respective terms
Source runtime	Python 3.10+, standard library (Tkinter)
Windows build	Standalone, installer-free EXE packaged using PyInstaller
Repository	github.com/DimitrisLai/Greek-to-greeklish-renamer
Support	GitHub Issues (use fictional example filenames)

New in version 2.1.1

- Use visible per-file checkboxes and one dynamic Select All / Select None button.
- Edit a selected row (or double-click) to fix incorrect transliterations manually.
- Prevent duplicate destinations, invalid names and unintended excluded child moves.
- Follow the live progress bar during large batches; Undo logs only completed changes.
- Existing CLI, original conversion engine and v2.0.0 release remain available.

PRIVACY AND RESPONSIBLE USE

The application operates locally. It does not upload filenames or file data. Keep separate backups, verify previews and avoid posting private folder paths in public issue reports.